

The Capability Formation Diagnostic

The twelve-statement diagnostic from The Capability Audit



Rate each statement from 1 (strongly disagree) to 5 (strongly agree), scored against the last ninety days of your actual working life, *not the life you intend to start living next quarter*.

PART ONE

Density *Learning Velocity*

- 1 In the last ninety days I have been handed a problem I did not already know how to solve. 1 2 3 4 5
- 2 I work close enough to people who are better than me that I can watch how they think. 1 2 3 4 5
- 3 My work is reviewed by someone who can tell the difference between good and adequate, and who says so directly. 1 2 3 4 5
- 4 The feedback I receive changes what I do next, not just how I feel. 1 2 3 4 5
- 5 I regularly operate at the edge of my competence rather than the comfortable center of it. 1 2 3 4 5
- 6 Looking back six months, the work I do now would have been genuinely hard for me then. 1 2 3 4 5

Add the six answers.
Your Density score

1	2	3	4	5	6	/ 30	



Optionality *Market Portability*

Reminder: Score only what has been true during the last ninety days, not what you hope will be true next quarter.

- 7 The capability I am building would be valued by an employer in a different industry. 1 2 3 4 5
- 8 I can describe what I do in terms of outcomes, not just my company's internal language. 1 2 3 4 5
- 9 If my role disappeared tomorrow, the capability I built would still be mine to carry. 1 2 3 4 5
- 10 People with the power to hire or advance me, inside or outside my company, can already see what I am good at. 1 2 3 4 5
- 11 What I am learning is a transferable capability rather than a company-specific procedure. 1 2 3 4 5
- 12 I could rebuild a strong position somewhere else within a year. 1 2 3 4 5

Add the six answers.
Your Optionality score

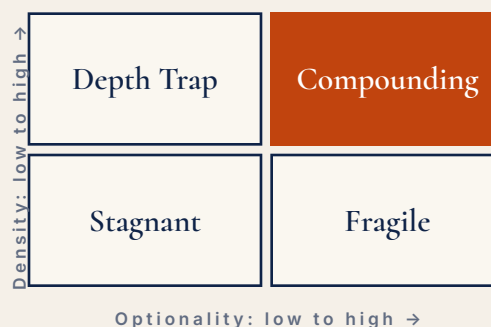
7	8	9	10	11	12	/ 30

Scoring and Placement

Treat 19 to 30 as high and 6 to 18 as low. Mark your square at right.



Any score between 17 and 21 sits close enough to the line to go either way, even a high one. Check here: *I am on a boundary and will read both neighboring states.*



Depth Trap. High Density, low Optionality. You are growing, and the growth is trapped where you stand.

Compounding. High Density and high Optionality. You are being formed and the market can carry it.

Stagnant. Low Density, low Optionality. Neither the learning nor the portability is moving.

Fragile. Low Density, high Optionality. Mobile on paper, hollowing underneath.

	MY DENSITY SCORE	MY OPTIONILITY SCORE	MY STATE	DATE
TODAY'S STATE	_____ / 30	_____ / 30	_____	_____



You've Finished the Diagnostic. Now What?

A note before you close this.

You have just completed the same twelve-statement diagnostic I put in front of readers of *The Capability Audit*. Before you put it away, three things matter.

First, check your framing. The most common mistake is scoring the life you intend to start living instead of the ninety days you actually lived. If an answer reflects intention instead of evidence, score it again. An intention is not evidence.

Second, treat your result seriously and lightly at the same time. Seriously, because your state, not your job title, shapes your exposure. Lightly, because this score is a map of where you stand today, not a measure of your worth. People move between states. I have watched them do it for eighteen years. These twelve statements sort people because they reflect the questions organizations quietly answer when deciding who grows, who stays, and who is replaceable. I did not invent them. I wrote down what I watched decide careers.

Third, remember what a self-score cannot do. It cannot tell you whether you scored yourself accurately. It cannot tell you what to do next. Both require another perspective. That is deliberate. The next steps below are built to provide it.

Temidayo Afonja

NEXT STEPS

SAVE YOUR SCORE

Keep the snapshot.
Watch the trend.

Today's score is a snapshot.
The trend matters more than a single number. Return in ninety days and compare.

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READ THE BOOK

The Capability Audit

The Diagnostic measures where you stand. The book explains why these twelve statements matter, introduces Capability Formation, and shows how Density and Optionality shape career resilience over time. Available on Kindle and in paperback.

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CALIBRATE YOUR SCORE

The Capability Formation Field Kit

A self-score cannot distinguish confidence from evidence. The Field Kit adds an evidence line under every score, three calibration checks that catch false numbers, and a plan for your next ninety days.

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P.S. Come back in ninety days. If your numbers move, tell me. Those are the stories I care about most.